Merced County Sheriff's Office - CA

ALPR Policy and Usage

Last Updated: Oct 28, 2026 05:05 AM -07:00

Overview

Merced County Sheriff's Office - CA uses Axon Automatic License Plate Reader (ALPR) technology to capture objective evidence without compromising individual privacy. We utilize real-time alerting in patrol vehicles to arrest wanted criminals, recover stolen vehicles and locate missing persons that are on various hotlists. We also retain vehicle and plate images for a period of time to perform searches when investigating reported crimes. All of this data is secure, not sold to 3rd parties, and only used for law enforcement purposes by authorized personnel. This page shows our ALPR policies and usage statistics so that you may understand how this technology is used to help keep your community safer.

ALPR Terms

Hotlist
A list of known license plates and vehicles of interest, which are stolen, wanted for or potentially associated with unlawful activity or missing persons.

Read Record
A record of a plate that was read that was not associated with any hotlist at the time it was captured.

Hit Record
A record of a plate that was read that matched a plate number on a hotlist and generated an alert.

What is detected

License plate image, vehicle image, plate text, date, time and location.

What is not detected

Facial images, people, gender, or race.

Acceptable Use Policy

Data is used for law enforcement purposes only. Data is agency-owned and is never sold to 3rd parties.

Prohibited Uses

Harassment, intimidation, usage based solely on a protected class (race, sex, religion, etc....), personal use.

Data Policy Access

All data searches require a valid search reason or case number which is captured in audit logs and stored indefinitely.

Hotlist Policy

Hotlist alerts are required to be human-verified before taking action.

Policy Settings

Plate Read Record Retention

30 Days

Hotlist Hit Record Retention

30 Days

Usage Metrics

Plate Reads Retained

733,836 Retained

Hotlist Hits Retained

69 Retained

Active ALPR Devices

in the last 30 days

65	65	0	0
Total	Fleet	Outpost	Lightpost